

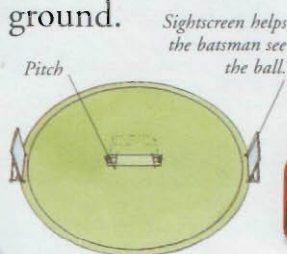
BALL GAMES



A WIDE VARIETY OF BALL GAMES is played around the world with all shapes and sizes of ball; on pitches, courts, courses, and tables; by teams and by individuals. As well as various football games and racket games, there are bat-and-ball games such as cricket and baseball, stick-and-ball games such as hockey, hurling, shinty, and golf; and billiard-table games such as pool, snooker, and billiards. Other ball games include basketball, which involves throwing a ball up and into a small hoop, volleyball, in which the ball is hit over a high net, and bowls, in which balls are rolled along the ground.

Cricket

This game is played between two teams of 11, one team bowling and fielding against two on the batting side. The batsmen score runs by running between the wickets or hitting the ball over the boundary. The fielding side may dismiss the batsmen in several ways, including bowling at and knocking over the wicket with the ball.



Cricket field

The field is usually oval but its size varies. The boundary is marked by a rope or white line. The pitch, situated at or near the middle of the field, measures 20.12 m (22 yd) between wickets and 3.05 m (10 ft) across.

Batting gloves



Bat made of willow



Wicket-keeping gloves



Helmet



Wicket keeping pads



Leather-cased ball



Wicket



Cricket equipment

Cricket is played with a hard ball, and many players wear protective clothing. The wicket-keeper and batsmen wear special gloves and strapped-on leg-pads. Batsmen and close fielders may wear helmets with face-guards.



Baseball

Baseball is played between two teams of nine which take turns to bat and field. A pitcher throws the ball and the batter attempts to hit it and score runs by progressing around four bases without being tagged or forced out by a fielder. The game has nine innings. An inning is over when six batters – three from each side – are out.



Catcher's glove with hard ball



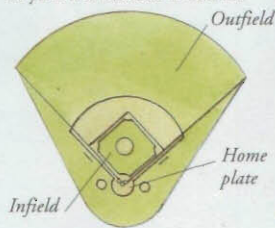
Catcher's mask

Bat



Baseball equipment

The catcher, who crouches behind the batter, wears a mask and body padding. Batters wear a helmet and fielders wear a catching mitt. The ball is made of cork wrapped in yarn and encased in leather.



Baseball field

The field is made up of an infield, or "diamond", and an outfield. A pitcher throws from a mound at the centre of the infield, which has a base at each corner. A batter stands at home base, or plate.

Babe Ruth

The sensational hitting of American baseball player Babe Ruth (1895–1948), brought crowds to baseball in the 1920s.

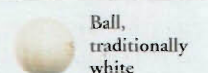
Originally a World Series-winning pitcher with the Boston Red Sox, he joined the New York Yankees in 1920 and slugged record after record, including 60 home runs in 1927 and a lifetime total of 714.



Hockey

This is played between two teams of 11. Each player has a hooked stick, only the flat side of which can be used for playing the ball. The object of the game is to hit the ball into the opponents' goal. Goals may be scored only from inside a semi-circle called the striking, or shooting, circle.

Ball, traditionally white

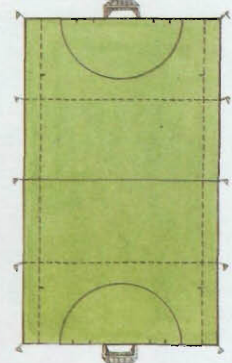


Goalkeeper's helmet

Hockey equipment

Players wear guards under their socks to protect their shins and ankles. The goalkeeper wears a helmet with a face mask, shoulder and elbow pads, padded gauntlets, substantial leg guards, and "kickers" over the boots to protect the feet when kicking the ball away.

Stick



Hockey pitch

The pitch measures 91.4 m x 54.9 m (100 yd x 60 yd). Goals are 3.66 m (12 ft) wide and 2.13 m (7 ft) high. The shooting circles are joined quarter circles drawn from each post.

Hurling

This is a 15-a-side game played with wooden sticks called hurleys, which are used to strike or carry a small, hard ball. Goals are like soccer goals with extended posts. Points are scored for hitting the ball under the crossbar (three points) or over it (one point).